KUTCH

THE MISSING LINK

A newly identified medieval settlement near Sir Creek is opening a window onto an unknown phase of Kutch—and possibly a lost branch of the Indus in today's salt desert

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Artist's impression

THE FIND

NAME: Provisionally called Barbadgaon, i.e. 'ruined village'

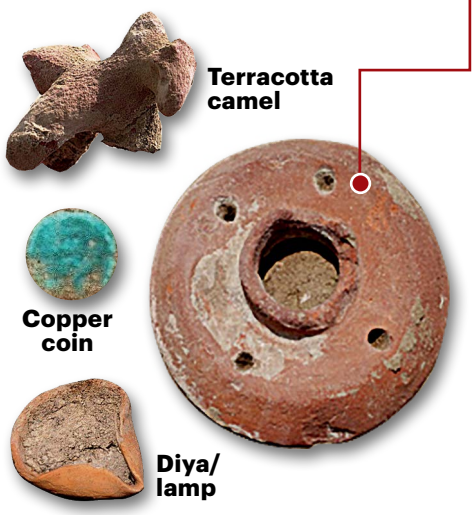
WHERE: Near Sir Creek, western Kutch, close to the Pakistan border

PERIOD: Provisionally, 11th-13th centuries CE (Soomra period)

DISCOVERY: First noticed by BSF personnel during patrols in 2023-24

RESEARCH INSTITUTES: KSKV Kachchh University, University of Oxford, Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences, Physical Research Laboratory, Deccan College

REMAINS FOUND: Human skeletons, terracotta rice-processing equipment, brick structures, pottery, lamps, domestic ceramics, a copper coin



THE RICE PUZZLE

- **Terracotta rice hullers** indicate that rice was being processed at the settlement
- Point to a medieval landscape with access to freshwater, very different from the salt desert we see today

THE BURIAL CLUE

- Around 100 human skeletons found at a burial ground, heads oriented towards the west
- Researchers believe the remains were naturally exposed following an earthquake





BRICKS IN THE SALT

- Brick enclosures, generally measuring about 3×3 metres, appear in sets of two or four
- Point to substantial built structures within the medieval settlement